

Sarah Da Yei Kim

Urban researcher and planner | M.S. in Urban Planning, Columbia University
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Housing systems; social stratification and inequality; stigmatization and class identity; gentrification and displacement; urban political economy; critical urban theory

EDUCATION

Columbia University, Graduate School of Architecture, Planning and Preservation | M.S. in Urban Planning, May 2026

Thesis: *Beyond Shelter: The Role of Korean Apartment Complexes in Middle-Class Identity and Social Stratification in Seoul*. Advisor: Tom Slater. *Nominated for the GSAPP Thesis/Capstone Award*.

Yokohama National University | B.A. in Urban Social Management, Mar 2020 | GPA: 4.077/4.5

Four-year merit-based scholarship recipient; graduation thesis compared drivers of urban development in Korean and European cities.

Exchange: Université Jean Moulin Lyon 3, France, Aug–Dec 2018

SELECTED RESEARCH AND WRITING * *Links embedded in the titles*

Beyond Shelter: The Role of Korean Apartment Complexes in Middle-Class Identity and Social Stratification in Seoul | Master's thesis, 2026

Mixed-methods study of apartment housing as a symbolic and material mechanism of class stratification and stigmatization in Seoul, combining interviews, GIS-based spatial analysis, and digital discourse and search-trend analysis.

Development for the Public? Gentrification and Displacement as the End of the World for Some | Research paper, 2026

Examines state-led redevelopment in Seoul's Ahyeon New Town through rent-gap theory, the revanchist city, and Peter Marcuse's typology of displacement, focusing on displacement, renter exclusion, and the multidimensional loss of home.

Mapping Displacement and Gentrification: A Machine Learning Approach to Urban Change | Group project, 2025

Applied machine-learning classification models to evaluate displacement patterns in Brooklyn using Peter Marcuse's typology of displacement.

Gentrification in Williamsburg: How Rezoning Changed the Neighborhood | Research project, 2024

Conducted a longitudinal GIS analysis of demographic, housing, and land-use change after the 2005 Williamsburg rezoning; selected for the 2024 GSAPP End-of-Year Show.

Public Rental Housing in South Korea: Stigmatization and the Failure of Social Mix | Research essay, 2025

Examines the stigmatization of public housing and its residents and the limitations of social-mix policies in South Korea.

PRESENTATIONS

Beyond Shelter: The Role of Korean Apartment Complexes in Middle-Class Identity and Social Stratification in Seoul | Scheduled presentation, New York Conference on Asian Studies, Oct 2026

Gentrification in Williamsburg: How Rezoning Changed the Neighborhood | Oral and poster presentation, Northeast Regional Conference of KSEA, Mar 2026

SELECTED AWARDS

Excellent Poster Award | NRC KSEA, 2026

GSAPP End-of-Year Show Selection | Columbia University GSAPP, 2024

CEO Award for Performance and Contribution | LG Energy Solution, 2024

Full Merit-Based Scholarship | Yokohama National University, 2015–2020

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Program Coordinator | Korean Cultural Center New York | New York City | Jul 2026–Present

Plan and coordinate performing arts and educational programs, including operations, community outreach, audience surveys, marketing, and program evaluation.

Capital Planning Intern | New York City School Construction Authority | New York City | Jun–Dec 2025

Managed public-school electrification and sustainability initiatives and supported interagency coordination, project-cost analysis, and regulatory interpretation.

Led a site review of prospective school locations in Queens, integrating site conditions, planning context, and relevant New York City local laws into recommendations.

Sales and Project Manager | LG Energy Solution | Seoul, South Korea | Jul 2020–May 2024

Led delivery of a \$125 million turnkey battery energy storage project in California, overseeing schedules, subcontractors, project risk, and cross-functional coordination.

Closed a \$600 million, 2.4 GWh grid-scale storage agreement and conducted cost, profitability, market, and policy analyses to inform strategy and partnerships.

Project Assistant Intern | CityNet Secretariat | Seoul, South Korea | Jan–Mar 2019

Structured Seoul public-policy cases for the Urban SDG Knowledge Platform and supported program operations and knowledge exchange among Asia-Pacific member cities.

Disaster Risk Management Intern | CityNet Yokohama Office | Yokohama, Japan | May–Jul 2018

Analyzed disaster-risk-reduction strategies across Korean member cities with a focus on public policy and local government administration.

METHODS AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Research methods: Qualitative interviews, mixed methods, spatial analysis, machine learning, digital discourse analysis

Geospatial and data: ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, R, Python

Design and web: Adobe Photoshop, InDesign, Illustrator, Figma, HTML, JavaScript

LANGUAGES AND MEMBERSHIP

Korean (native) | **English** (near-native) | **Japanese** (fluent; JLPT N1) | **French** (basic)

American Planning Association | Member, 2026–Present

The Korea Society | Member, 2025–Present